

Jay Fernando

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Active U.S. Secret Clearance

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

B.A., Statistics, B.A., Political Economy

Fall 2026

Berkeley, CA

- Concentration: Indo-Pacific Trade and Security; Minor: Public Policy (The Goldman School)

Relevant Coursework: International Trade, National Security Policy, National Security Resilience Accelerator - Hacking for Defense (H4D), Peace and Security in Northeast Asia, South Asian Politics, Statistical Prediction and Machine Learning, Linear Statistical Models, Experimental Design, Game Theory, Macroeconomics (math intensive), Microeconomics

WORK EXPERIENCE

Lawrence Livermore National Laboratory (LLNL)

Defense, Science and Technology Intern

July 2025 – Sep 2025

Livermore, CA

- Stabilized safety compliance system by developing a simple interface for engineers to identify required standards.
- Created timeline visualization of federal nuclear regulations using 30 years of LLNL testing site contracts.
- Built standard-by-standard database with R and Excel according to specific facility requirements for glovebox exhaust, fire suppression, and other engineering safety systems.

Institute for Research on Labor and Employment (IRLE)

Undergraduate Research Intern

Sep 2024 – May 2025

Berkeley, CA

- Constructed and cross-validated dataset of ruling party coalitions over 75 years of Indian governmental records.
- Analyzed Indian matrimonial sites to identify links between marriageability and female educational outcomes.
- Conducted comprehensive review of labor contract laws affecting informal textile workers in South/Southeast Asia.

Air Force ROTC

Cadet Wing Commander | June 2025 - Dec 2025

Aug 2022 – Dec 2025

Berkeley, CA

- Lead for all training and cadet operations for 100+ cadets.
- Launched digitization campaign including centralized website, continuity archive, and regular statistical reports.
- Redesigned curriculum to emphasize modern wargaming and simulation exercises, while achieving 100% of conventional objectives in 50% of the allotted time.
- Awards: Daughters of Founders and Patriots of America; AFROTC Commendation Award (top 10% of cadets)

SKILLS

Foreign Languages: English (Native), Tamil (Native), French (Advanced), Japanese (Intermediate)

Programming Languages: R, Python, Java, JavaScript, SQL

Libraries/Frameworks: Scikit-Learn, LightGBM, Pandas, SciPy, React

Software & Tools: ArcGIS Pro/Online, MS Excel, Git, Word

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

DIANA (H4D Project - Sponsored by SpaceWERX and NASA) | AWS Bedrock

- LLM matching algorithm translating commercial launch requirements into military logistics language.

New York Taxi Response Time | Python, Scikit-learn, LightGBM, Pandas

- Forecasting model using gradient-boosting to predict taxi ride timing with minimal latency.

What are UC Workers Bargaining For? | JavaScript, React, Github ([The Daily Californian](#))

- Real-time tracker of UC academic worker labor contract negotiations during Fall 2022 strike.

Eudemonia (Congressional App Challenge Winner - 2020) | JavaScript, GitHub

California Partisan Prediction Map | ArcGIS Online, Living Atlas

EXTRACURRICULARS / VOLUNTEER WORK

BareStage Productions

Producer, Financial Director, Performer, BarePage Ensemble

Aug 2022 – May 2026

Berkeley, CA

- Founded the [Rimlower Prize](#), a \$2000 crowdfunded grant annually awarded to a production that advances equity in the performing arts; produced *JUMP* - the inaugural awardee.
- Grew organizational budget from \$13,000 to \$42,000 through full market and expense audit

- Wrote/directed 15 staged pieces and performed in student-written, produced, and acted works. ([Cyrano](#); [Hamlet](#))

Political Economy Department - UC Berkeley

Jan 2025 - May 2026

Lead Peer Advisor

Berkeley, CA

- Advised 450+ students in the Political Economy major on course planning and extracurricular opportunities.
- Planned and staffed new admit panels and advising workshops for students in the major.
- Led peer advising team meetings to coordinate recommendations and event planning.

Berkeley Engineers and Mentors

Aug 2022 – Dec 2024

Mentor

Berkeley, CA

- Taught STEM lessons encouraging early exposure to technical topics for underserved K-6th graders across the Bay Area.
- Prepared semesterly ‘final lesson,’ a capstone experiment specific to a single class’ interests.

Redlands Unified School District

Jan 2020 – May 2021

Coding Tutor

Redlands, CA

- Instructed 1st-3rd graders in introductory Python and block code using Hour of Code.
- Constructed and taught complimentary curriculum including important figures and events in the history of computing.
- Collaborated with a team of tutors to improve teaching methods and student retention.

INTERESTS: Tech and security policy, data visualization, food blogging/experimental recipes, scriptwriting, *Pacific Rim*